

Joseph McKendra Thoburn

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Research Interests

Urban Economics, Housing Markets, Land Use Regulations, Public Finance

Education

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, Chapel Hill, NC
Ph.D. in Economics

Expected May 2031

University of Virginia, Charlottesville, VA
B.A. Economics, Financial Economics Concentration
B.A. Mathematics, Financial Mathematics Concentration
Cumulative GPA: 3.831 (with Distinction)

May 2026

Technical Skills: Stata, R, Python, MATLAB, LaTeX

Research

Undergraduate Thesis: [“Z Is for Zoning: An Examination of the Heterogeneous Effects of Land-Use Regulation Changes on Housing Prices”](#)

- Examined how changes in land-use regulations affect housing prices heterogeneously across market conditions using a first-difference design.
- Built a consistent land-use regulatory index by harmonizing Wharton survey responses.
- Awarded High Honors.

Research Experience

Research Assistant, Colin Williams, Ph.D. Candidate at the University of Virginia, Remote

Summer 2025

- Funded by the Marshall Jevons Undergraduate Research Fund.
- Examined the effect of the 1999 manufactured home credit market crash on homeownership and fertility in rural communities using an event study design with Census microdata.

Research Assistant, Anne Rathbone Bradley, Ph.D. at the Institute of World Politics, Remote

Summer 2024

- Contributed to an [article](#) on the impacts of tariffs on domestic toaster production.
- Conducted a literature review on female labor force participation and family formation.

Teaching Experience

Undergraduate Teaching Fellow, University of Virginia, Charlottesville, VA

Aug 2024 – May 2026

- Led discussion sections for Principles of Microeconomics and Macroeconomics.
- Held office hours and graded exams.